that they can legitimately boast of in their lands of domicile. In a more globalized world, they inevitably emerged as a more effective bridge to India. At the same time, a confident India has also taken pride in their successes and not shied away from a visible relationship.

In some ways, the Indian diaspora is quite unique because, in contrast with those of other societies, its mobility was not driven by turmoil at home. On the contrary, its bonding with Mother India has grown emotionally stronger with the advent to power of a more authentic representative. The 2014 event at Madison Square Garden marks a new era in diaspora connectivity. Its role has acquired greater value at both ends of the chain. For foreign policy, this may mean some additional responsibilities but surely provides greater sources of support. As a result, initiatives pertaining to the diaspora have expanded so as to strengthen its bonding with India.

Sensible foreign policies obviously have to address bread and butter issues. However, there are bigger questions to consider as well, especially for large nations. Three contemporary examples of urgent global concerns are pandemics, terrorism and climate change. No country can really afford to be oblivious or indifferent to such challenges. Smaller states are impacted; larger ones even more so. For a nation like India, quite apart from their direct consequences, there is also the need to shape the direction of global debate. This, therefore, becomes as much an exercise of responsibility as of influence.

An examination of the recent record on these matters offers some learnings. India has been a major factor in global deliberations regarding the countering of terrorism. If the awareness of those threats is more or the tolerance is less, our efforts have made no small difference. On climate change, India not only helped forge a consensus in Paris in 2015 but, in contrast to many others, has stayed true to its commitments. In Glasgow in 2021, these were taken to an even higher level. The International Solar Alliance (ISA) and the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI) are two notable examples of its leadership in climate action. On the pandemic, its supply of medicines and vaccines and deployment of teams abroad spoke volumes about its internationalism.

In the decade that has passed, the new energy in India’s endeavours is evident, notably in PM Modi’s own engagements. Indian diplomacy has changed profoundly, be it in terms of bilateral visits, collective summits,